How To Actually Make $10,000/Month On Shopify (The Truth)

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: Nov 13, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cQN7izW849I Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Arie Scherson shares his real Shopify playbook — find trending products, source them cheaply from China (no branding needed), test demand with $50/day Meta ads, then scale and brand once profitable. His own brand does $700K/month.

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🏆 Who Is Arie & Why Listen To Him 0:23

- Runs an e-commerce brand doing **$700,000/month** in revenue, built with a business partner
- Also owns an advertising agency that spends heavily on paid ads
  - Agency has achieved Meta's highest tier: **"Agency Partner" status** on the Meta platform
  - Spends over **$10 million per year** on Meta ads across clients, with his own brand approaching the same spend
- Has been running dropshipping stores with Team Drop for years before scaling to custom inventory
- Core message: there is more information noise than ever, but the fundamentals are simple — his goal is to cut through the clutter

🔍 Step 1: Find a Winning Product 0:70

- The single most important element is **the product** — everything else (ads, store) is secondary
- Two main ways to identify trending products:

    - **Pluto Hunt** — a research platform Arie built with his team; shows trending products and competitors' ads
    - **Google Trends** — free, publicly available, useful for validating demand trajectory
- Key principle: look for products that are *rising* but not yet peaked
    - Example of a product to avoid: red light therapy masks — market is now oversaturated
        - Best window was 2024–2025; now too crowded unless you offer an unusually low price or a compelling unique angle
    - Example of a product to pursue: **meal prep food containers** — trending upward and still in early stages as of this video
        - 8-piece set available for ~$14 including shipping from China
        - Retail price range: $80–$100
        - Strong margins and growing search interest

💰 Step 2: Source It Cheaply (Red Light Mask Example) 0:118

- Arie bought a red light therapy mask for his mother through his China sourcing platform
    - Cost: **~$54 including shipping**
    - Delivery time: **12 days** (direct from China — standard timeline)
    - The mask had **no brand label** — it arrives as a generic/unbranded product
- The same mask sells on Google shopping results for **$159** at some retailers
    - Some sellers list it even lower (sub-$5 range), showing wide price variation
- Core insight: the gap between your sourcing cost and retail price is your margin opportunity
    - Buying at $54, selling at $150 = meaningful margin to fund ads
- Platform used: **Team Drop** — Arie's preferred sourcing/dropshipping platform
    - Products are unbranded by default, which is fine for initial testing
    - No need for custom packaging or branding to start

> The product is the most important element. Everything else — ads, store design, branding — comes second.

🏪 Step 3: Set Up Your Shopify Store 1:379

- Go to **akemi.co/shopify** for the latest Shopify deal
    - Current offer: **$1/month for 3 months**
    - Also receive up to **$10,000 in credits** (described as a valuable add-on)
- Setting up the store itself is straightforward — Shopify handles the infrastructure
- Use AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude, etc.) to help write product descriptions, ad copy, and anything else needed
- You do NOT need a fully branded, polished store to begin — test first, refine later

📦 Step 4: Use Team Drop for Fulfillment 1:403

- **Team Drop** is Arie's top-recommended dropshipping/fulfillment app
  - Free to use — no upfront cost
  - Integrates directly with Shopify
  - Visit **akemi.co/sourcing** to browse their product catalog
- Key feature: Team Drop curates **"winning product" selections** based on their internal sales data
  - These picks are data-driven, not just editorial guesses
- Dropshipping model means you **only purchase inventory after a customer has already paid you**
  - Zero inventory risk at the start
- Shipping time is ~12 days from China — acceptable for most customers willing to wait
  - Arie notes: the majority of customers are willing to wait if expectations are set properly

📣 Step 5: Run Meta Ads 0:188

- Meta ads (Facebook/Instagram) are described as essential — "you need Meta ads, they work"
- Getting started:
  - Search Google for "Facebook for Business"
  - Create a Meta Ads account
  - Launch your first campaigns
- Recommended starting budget: **$50/day**
- Launch approximately **10 ads** at the start to test creative variations
- How to create ad creatives:
  - Browse your own news feed to spot what's working organically
  - Use **Pluto Hunt Discovery Tool** to view competitors' active ads
  - Save winning ads to a folder, paste them into ChatGPT, and ask it to recreate the concept for your product
  - Tools also mentioned: **Higgs Field**, Google, Claude
- AI is now handling a large portion of Arie's ad workflow — he describes it as "amazing" and credits AI with freeing up significant time
- Coming soon (mentioned but not yet released): tools that will manage all Meta ads automatically on your behalf

🧪 Step 6: Test Demand Before Committing 0:284

- Simple math framework for validating a product:

Scenario	Numbers
Daily ad spend	$50
Test duration	5 days
Total test budget	$250
Sell price example	$150
Sales needed to break even	~2 sales over 5 days
Even 1 sale/day	Covers ad spend and starts stacking profit

- If you get even one sale per day at $150 while spending $50/day, you're profitable — money accumulates quickly
- Key rule: **do not over-invest before proving demand**
  - No need for custom branding, custom packaging, or bulk inventory on day one
  - Unbranded product + basic Shopify store + $50/day ads = enough to test
- Red light mask caveat: even though the margin math works on paper ($54 cost, $150 sell price), Arie advises against it *now* because the market is saturated
  - If forced to price at $99 to compete, margin becomes too thin to profitably run Meta ads
  - Better to find a less crowded rising trend

📈 Step 7: Scale and Build a Real Brand 1:334

- Once you have proof of demand and a profitable ad system, *then* invest in building a brand
- Scaling steps (in order):
  - Contact your Team Drop agent to begin branding the product
  - Add custom inner packaging / inserts
  - Consider importing inventory into the US for faster domestic shipping
  - Explore Amazon FBA as a channel once you have US-based stock
- Arie's own brand followed this exact path:
  - Started with simple dropshipping via Team Drop
  - Graduated to custom/private label inventory once demand was proven
  - Now scaling to the US, including plans to **open a manufacturing facility in the United States**
- Core philosophy: start simple → prove demand → layer in complexity and branding → scale
  - "We built this by starting with very simple steps"

🛠️ Tools & Resources Mentioned 0:70

- **Pluto Hunt** — Arie's proprietary product research and competitor ad discovery platform
- **Team Drop** — dropshipping fulfillment app (free); akemi.co/sourcing

- **Shopify** — store platform; akemi.co/shopify ($1/month for 3 months + up to $10K credits)
- **Meta Ads (Facebook for Business)** — primary paid traffic channel
- **ChatGPT / Claude** — AI tools for ad copy, product descriptions, creative ideation
- **Higgs Field** — mentioned as an alternative ad creative platform
- **Google Trends** — free trend research tool
- **Google Shopping** — useful for checking competitor retail pricing on any product